



Active Transportation & the Built Environment

Accessibility, Design, and Planning

Fall 2026

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City & Regional Planning

Where are We Going?

W1: "How do you define walkability?"

**Background
Concept**

W2 S2: Walkable for whom? Where?
Trip purpose and competing impacts

W3: Space and place
How streets are experienced

W4 S1: Space and place
comfort, safety, and staying

Conceptualization

Formulating a **systematized concept**
through reasoning about the **background concept**,
in light of the goals of research.

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W4 S2: Walk/rollability as a systematized concept

W5 S1: Urban accessibility as a systematized concept

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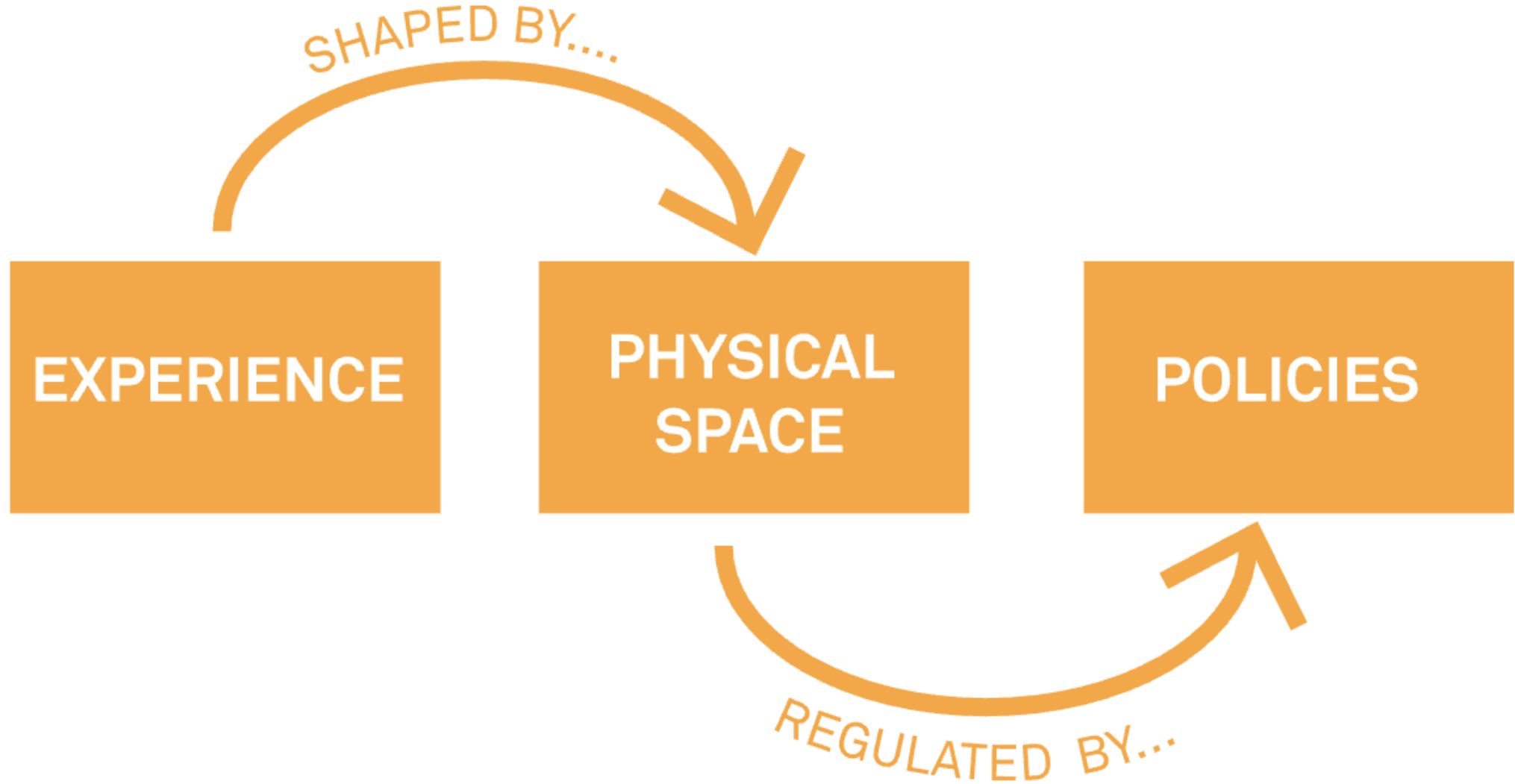
Systematized Concepts *Definition!*

A specific formulation of a concept used by
a given scholar or group of scholars;
commonly involves an explicit definition.

"Nothing is experienced by itself,
but always in relation to its surroundings,
the sequences of events leading up to it,
the memory of past experiences."

Kevin Lynch, *The Image of the City*, P.2

Is something missing?



Lynch

To identify qualities of physical environment that most strongly shape peoples' images of their city.

The Image of the City "considers the visual quality of the American city by studying the **mental image of that city which is held by its citizens.**"

"What we seek is not a final but an open-ended order, capable of continuous further development!"

Kevin Lynch, The Image of the City

How did Lynch define "legibility" or "imageability"?

3 parts of city image

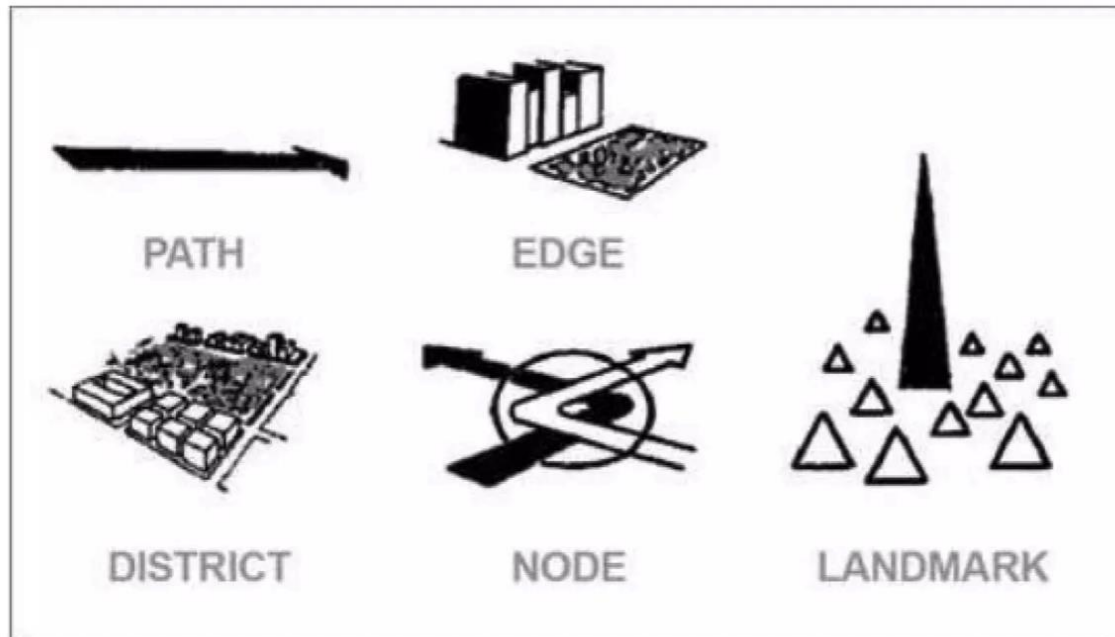
- 1. Identity:** An element in the environment can be distinguished from other elements.
- 2. Structure:** The spatial pattern of the element in relation to other elements.
- 3. Meaning:** The personal significance of the element.

Imageability: the ease with which the parts of a city can be recognized by its users.

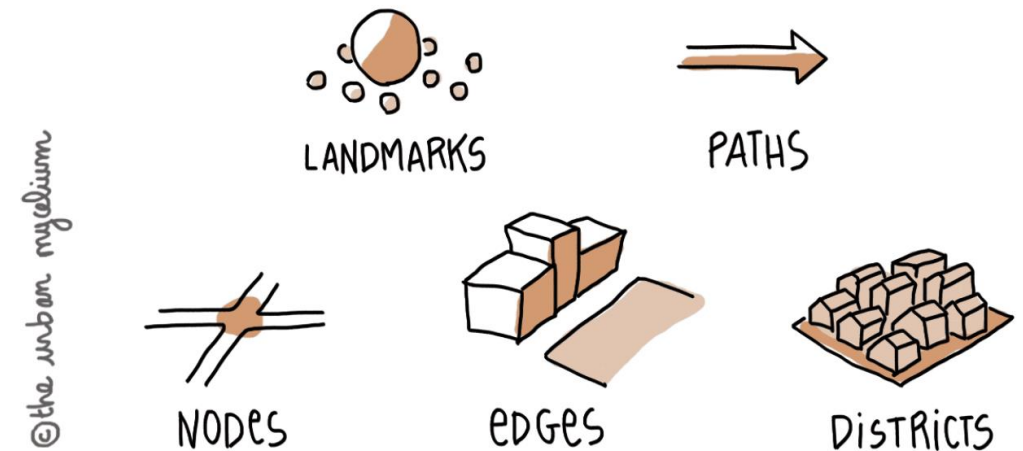
Elements of the City Image

- **Path:** Channels along which people move, (streets, walkways)
- **Landmark:** A physical reference point that is viewed from the outside. (buildings, mountain)
- **Edge:** A linear boundary or break between two areas, such as a shoreline, wall, railroad, or edge of development.
- **Node:** A strategic point that people can enter and that serves as a focus of movement or activity, (intersection, transit stop)
- **District:** A medium to large area of the city with a recognizable character that people can mentally enter and identify as a distinct part of the city.

Elements of the City Image

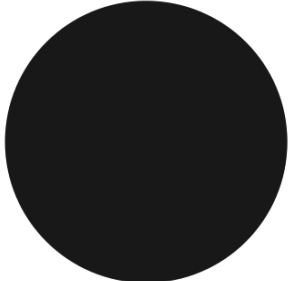


HOW WE REMEMBER THE CITY (LYNCH, 1960)



Jan Gehl: Activity Types

- Necessary / functional
- Optional / recreational
- Social

	Quality of the physical environment	
	Poor	Good
Necessary activities		
Optional activities		
“Resultant” activities (Social activities)		



60 km/h architecture

**Large spaces, huge signage,
no details, no people**





Human scale, many details, interaction

A man and a young child are walking away from the camera on a paved path in a park. The man is wearing a blue and black plaid shirt and khaki shorts, and the child is wearing a light blue patterned shirt and white shorts. They are holding hands. The background is filled with green trees and foliage, with a black lamppost visible on the right side of the path.

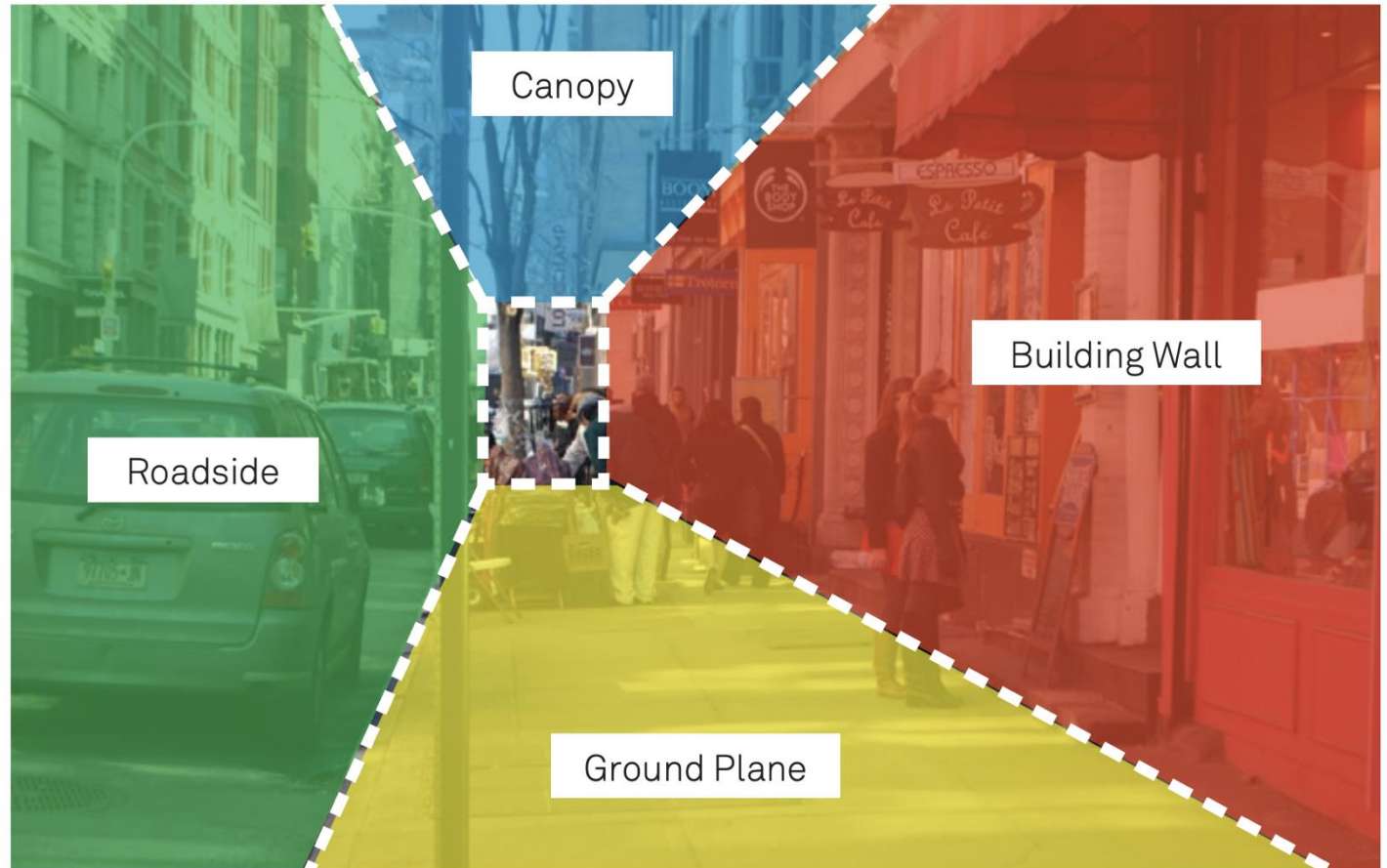
We are still homo sapiens
Walking speed: 2 miles/h

"The ballet of the good city sidewalk
never repeats itself from place to
place, and in any one place is always
replete with new improvisations."

Jane Jacobs, *Death and Life of Great American Cities*, P.50

The Sidewalk Room

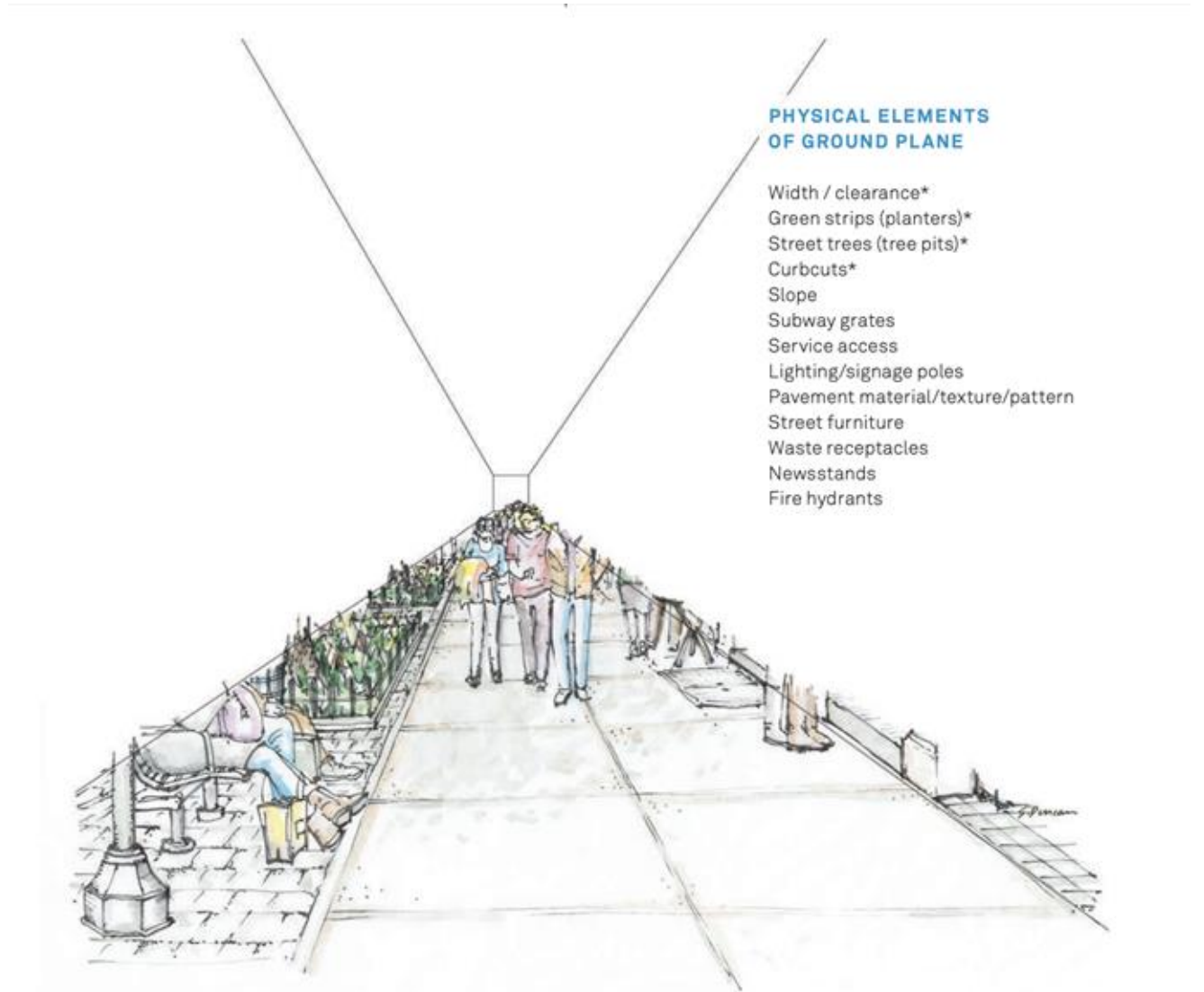
Judging from the pedestrian perspective, the sidewalk is conceptualized as a room with four planes.



Ground Plane

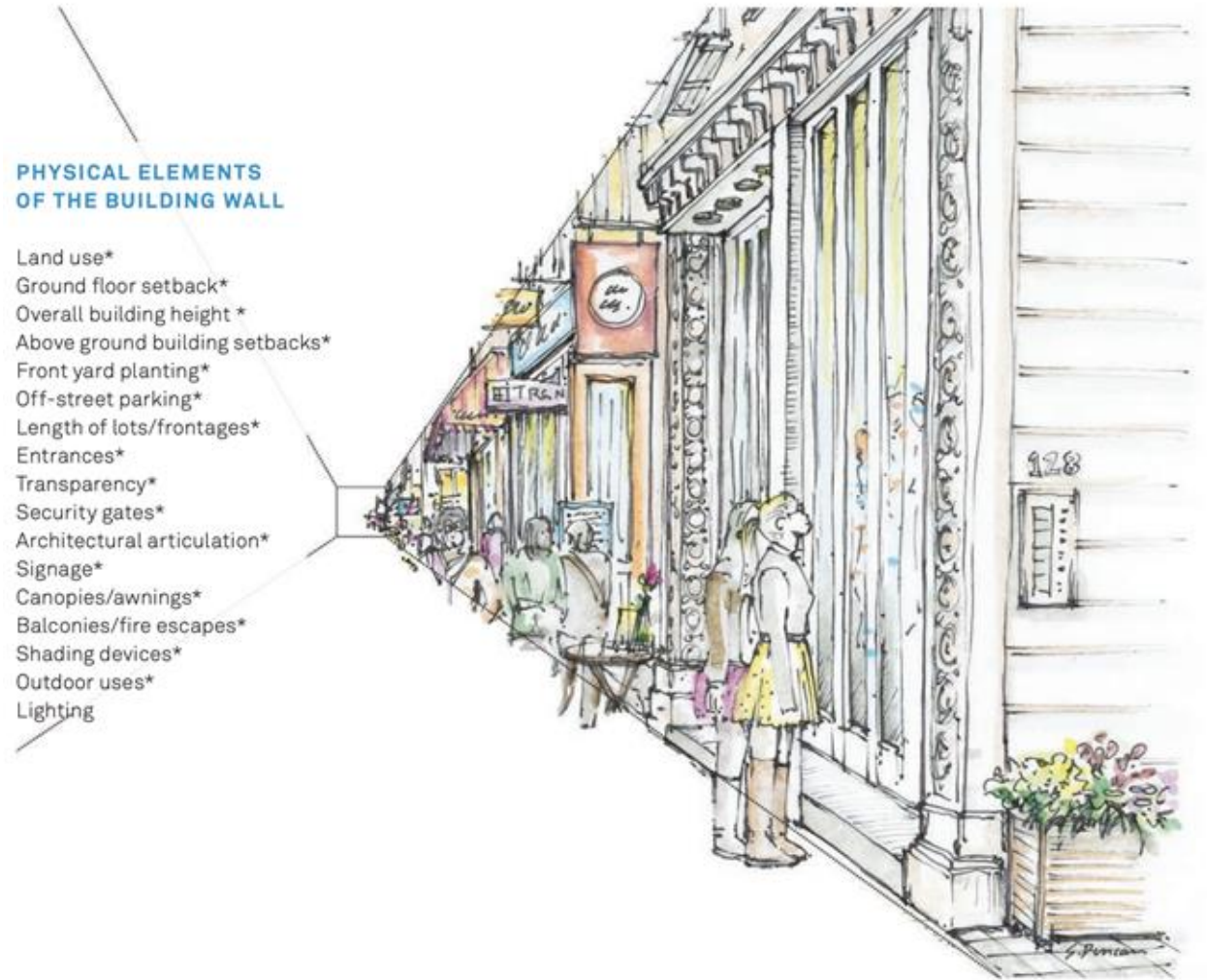
Four Different Zones :

1. Frontage Zone
2. Pedestrian Through Zone
3. Furnishing Zone
4. Buffer / Curb Zone



Building Wall

Zoning regulations typically have the greatest impact on this plane. The position of the building wall plane (set back or on the property line), can greatly affect the sidewalk experience.

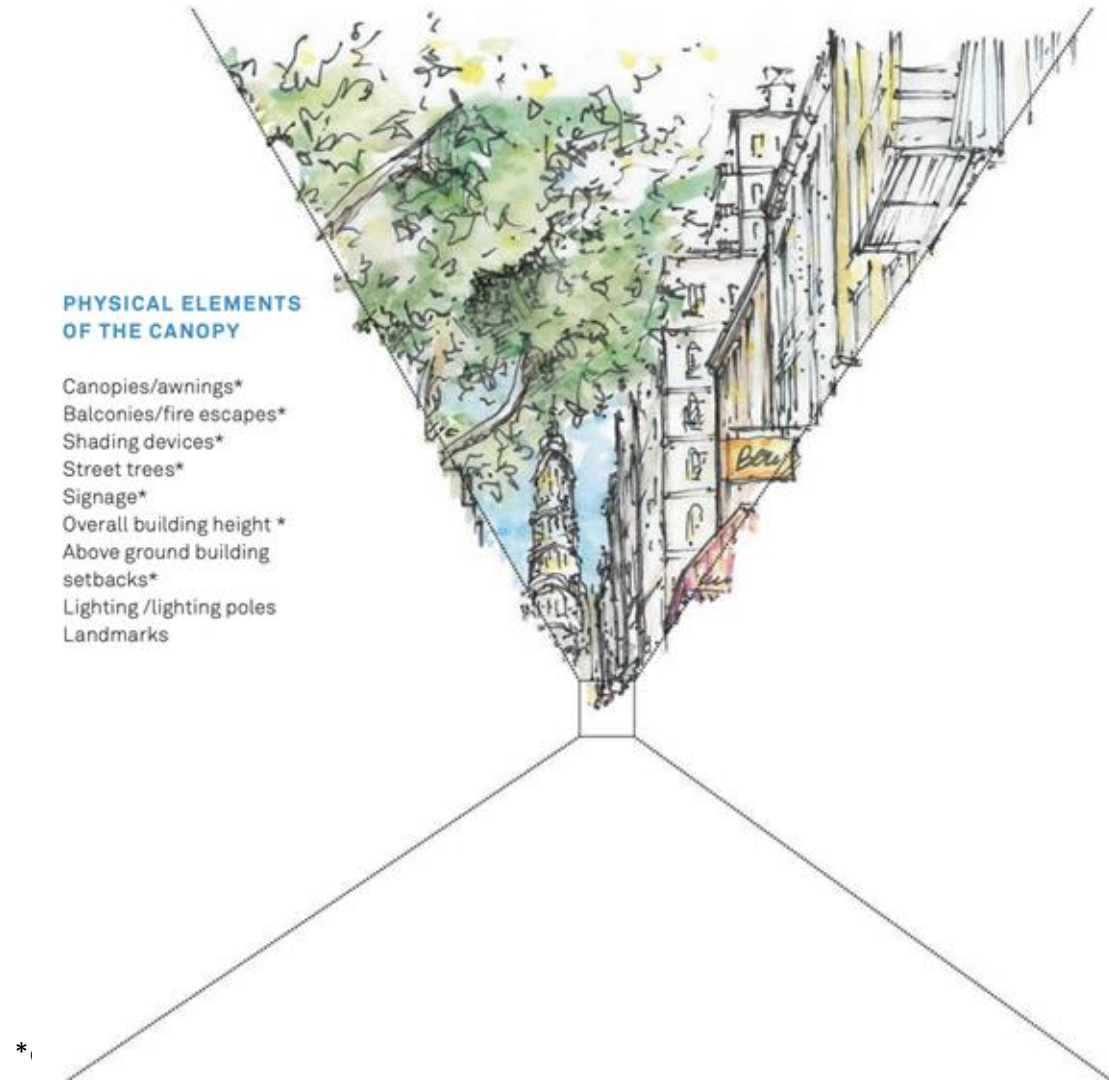


*elements affected by zoning

Canopy

The amount of sky apparent to pedestrians.

Sidewalks lined with trees provide a strong and diverse canopy filled with tree branches or heavy foliage and change seasonally.



Roadside

Defined primarily by the rhythm of vertical physical elements like tree trunks and light poles that line the immediate edge of the sidewalk.

Safety from accident

Depth of view



PHYSICAL ELEMENTS OF THE ROADSIDE PLANE

- Green strips/ planters/ tree pits*
- Street trees*
- Lighting/signage poles
- Street vendors
- Parked cars
- Bike lanes
- Bike racks
- Street furniture
- Waste Receptacles
- Newsstands
- Fire hydrants

*elements affected by zoning

Sidewalks

Factors Contributing to Active Design Experience

SUSTAINABILITY + RESILIENCE: Consider local context regarding climate, plantings + trees, materials, air quality and storm water management.

SAFETY: Ensure sidewalks are designed with adequate lighting, gradients, and materials, to enable safe use 24 hours a day.

HUMAN SCALE + COMPLEXITY: Use architectural detailing, entries, transparency, landscaping and so on to increase the complexity at the lower floors, helping to complement the human scale and break down the rhythm of length of the sidewalk.



CONTINUOUS VARIETY: Ensure an experience of continuous variety. Consider the different speeds that people move at, and a variety of activities that can occur within the sidewalk room.

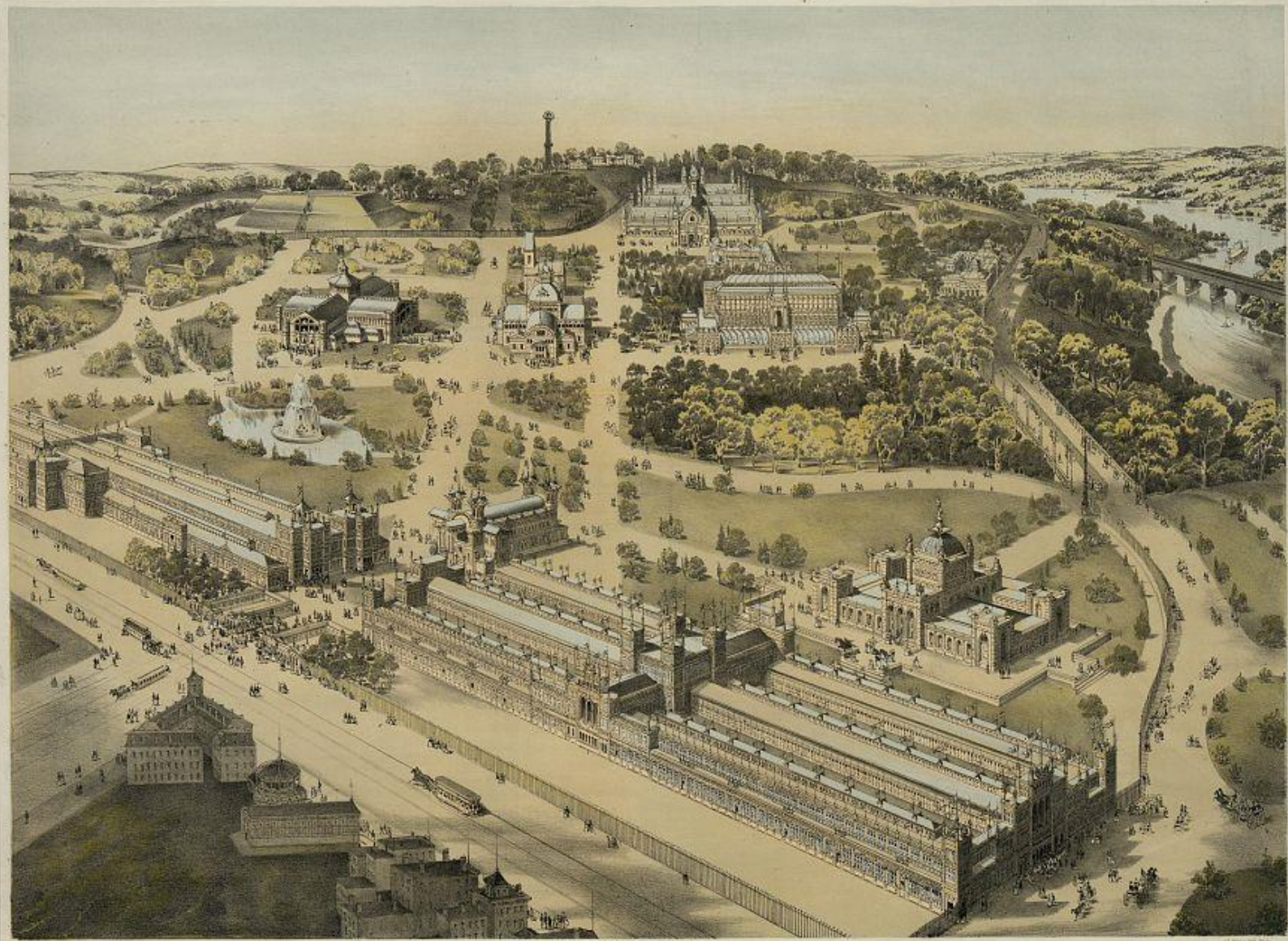
CONNECTIVITY: Ensure sidewalks provide clear wayfinding and are continuous, connecting people to destinations and not resulting in dead ends.

ACCESSIBILITY: Ensure accessibility for multiple users, considering different ages and abilities.

Sidewalk Regulations (NYC)

Factors Contributing to Active Design Experience





MARKET HALL

U. S. GOVERNMENT BUILDING

LEGATION HALL

LARGE PAVILION

AGRICULTURAL HALL

PHOTOGRAPHIC HALL

MEMORIAL HALL

MAIN EXHIBITION BUILDINGS

ALL WOOD FOR PAINT

VIEW OF THE GROUND AND BUILDINGS INTERNATIONAL EXHIBITION.

FAIRMOUNT PARK

1876.

PHILADELPHIA.

REPRODUCED

Draw from Memory

Without using your phone or looking at a map:

- **Draw a map of Berkeley as you picture it in your mind.**
- Draw enough that someone looking at your map could understand **how you think the city is organized.**
- Include whatever places, routes, boundaries, areas, or features come naturally to mind.
- Add names or annotations if useful.
- Do not worry about geographic accuracy.
- There is no need to fill the entire page or represent all of Berkeley.
- **Do not compare maps yet.**

Read your Map through Lynch

Now look back at your map and identify:

Paths: routes you move along

Edges: boundaries or breaks

Districts: recognizable areas

Nodes: important points of activity or decision

Landmarks: recognizable reference points

Mark each type directly on your drawing. Then ask yourself:

Which types appear most strongly in my mental image? Which are missing?

Share Maps

In groups of **3 - 4**, compare your maps.

Discuss:

1. What appears on many maps?
2. What appears on only one map?
3. What was exaggerated, simplified, or omitted?
4. Where do your mental boundaries of Berkeley differ?
5. What might explain these differences?

Choose **one similarity and one striking difference** to share with the class.

Our Maps of Berkeley

What does our collection of maps tell us about Berkeley?

Are we mapping Berkeley, or are we mapping our experience of Berkeley?

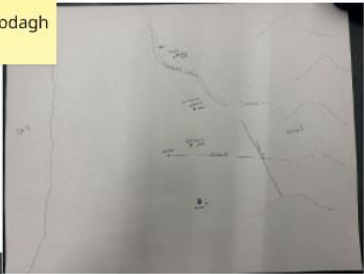
*take a picture and add
your map to this Miro
board!*



The image of Berkeley

W3 S2 - Sp 9 2026

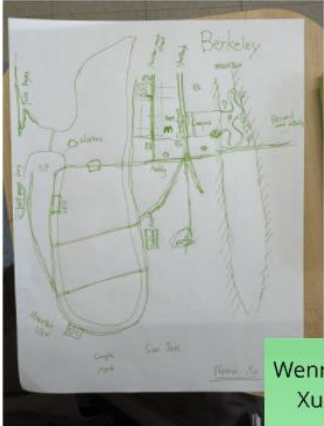
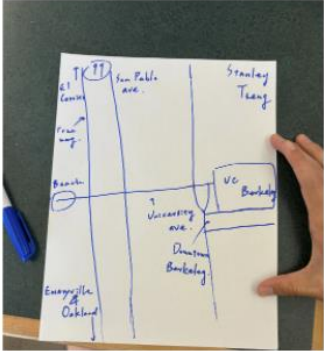
Clodagh



Brandon Leggins

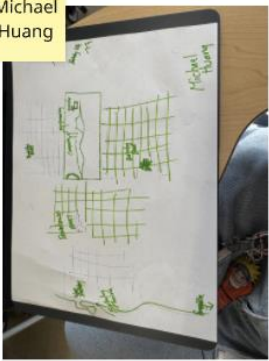


Bryce Miller

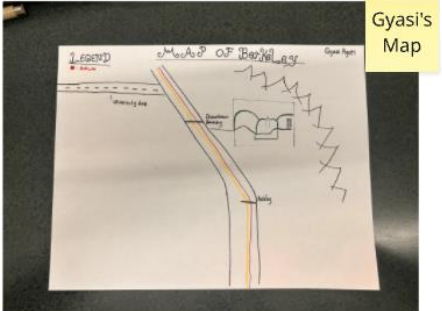
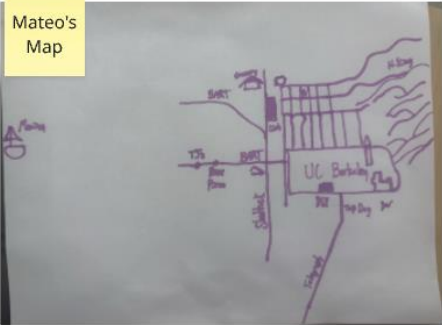


Wenrui Xu

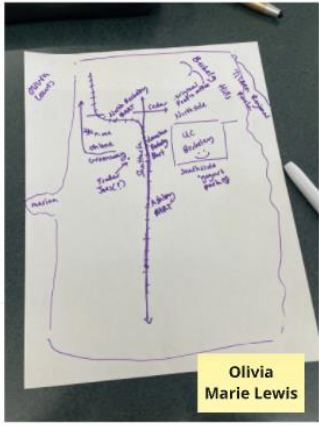
Michael Huang



Mateo's Map



Gyasi's Map

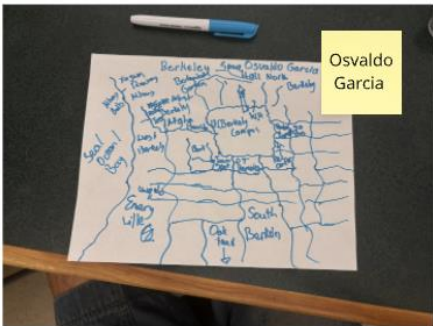


Olivia Marie Lewis

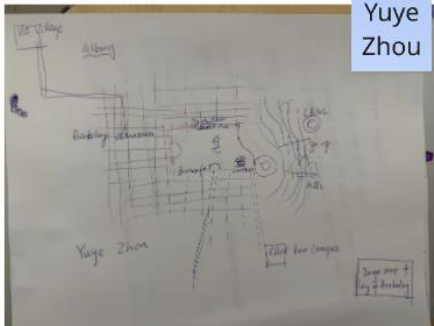
julie



Oswaldo Garcia



Yuye Zhou

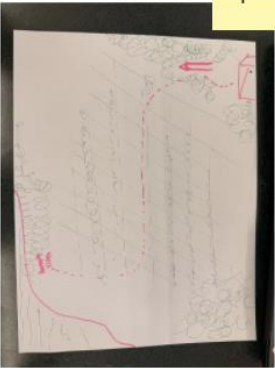


Adriana

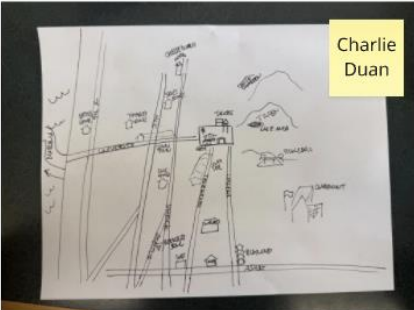


Rico Daga

Aqdas



Charlie Duan



Anwar

